

Short-Term Rental Tracker

Setup & User Guide · Airbnb / VRBO / direct-booking hosts · IRS Schedule E ready

What you bought

A single, formula-driven spreadsheet that does your short-term-rental bookkeeping for you. Log each booking and expense once, and the workbook automatically organizes everything into a tax-ready **IRS Schedule E** summary and a live profit dashboard — per property. No subscriptions, no logins, no monthly fees. It's yours forever.

The 6 tabs

Tab	What it's for
Start Here	A one-page overview and tips. Read this first.
Setup	Type your property names (up to 5). Everything else links to them automatically.
Transactions	Your logbook. Add one row per income or expense. This is the only tab you touch daily.
Categories	Reference list of every category and its matching Schedule E line. Feeds the dropdowns.
Schedule E Summary	Fills itself in. Every expense mapped to the correct Schedule E line, per property.
Dashboard	Live totals: net profit, income vs. expenses, by property and by month.

Get started in 4 steps

- **1. Name your properties.** Open the **Setup** tab and type each property name in column B (replace the sample names). You can have up to 5.
- **2. Delete the sample data.** The **Transactions** tab has 8 example rows so you can see how it works. Once you understand it, delete those rows (select rows 4–11, right-click, Delete) before adding your own.
- **3. Log a transaction.** On **Transactions**, fill one row: pick the Date, choose the Property and Type (Income / Expense) from the dropdowns, pick a Category, enter the Amount. The Month column fills in by itself.
- **4. Read your reports.** Open **Schedule E Summary** and **Dashboard** any time — they update the instant you add a row. Nothing to refresh.

How to log bookings the right way (important)

- **Log the GROSS payout as income, and the platform's cut as an expense.** Example: a guest pays \$1,240. Enter \$1,240 as *Rental income (nightly)*, then enter Airbnb's \$46.50 host fee as a separate *Commissions / platform fees* expense. That's exactly how it should appear on Schedule E.
- **Cleaning fees you collect** are income (*Cleaning fee collected*); what you pay your cleaner is an expense (*Cleaning and maintenance*).

- **Occupancy / lodging taxes** you collect and remit go under *Taxes (incl. occupancy tax)*.
- **One transaction per row.** Don't combine. The more granular you are, the cleaner your tax summary.

Use it in Excel or Google Sheets

Excel / Numbers: just open the .xlsx file.

Google Sheets: go to Google Drive → New → File upload → select the .xlsx. Then open it and choose *File* → *Save as Google Sheets*. All formulas, dropdowns and reports carry over.

Each tax year

Keep one file per year. At the start of a new year, make a copy and rename it (e.g. "STR Tracker 2027"), then clear the Transactions rows. Your prior year stays untouched for your records.

Disclaimer. This template is a bookkeeping organizer, not tax, legal, or accounting advice. The Schedule E line mapping is provided for convenience only. Tax rules vary by situation and jurisdiction — always confirm your specific filing with a qualified tax professional before submitting. Made with spreadsheet software; design and formulas by the seller.